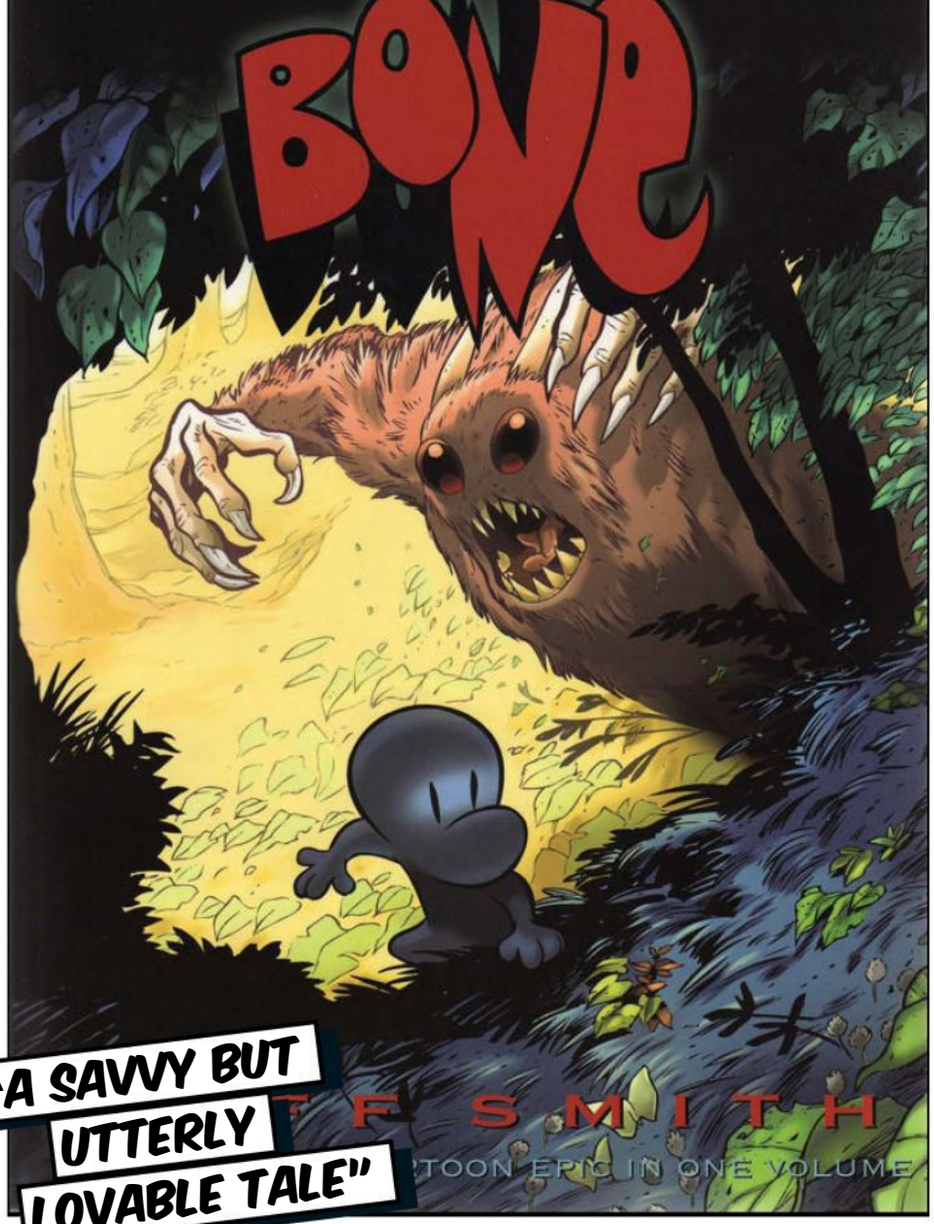


BONE

Details **Originally published** Bone #1-55 (1991-2004) **Publisher** Image
Writer Alison Bechdel **Artist** Jeff Smith **Collected in** Bone
Available digitally Comixology

Collected into a single volume, Jeff Smith's *Bone* series reveals itself as a true fantasy epic. There's the hero's journey, as Fone Bone and his friends Phoney and Smiley Bone realise that they must act to help save the Valley from The Hooded One and his rat creatures, there are the good-hearted folk who must be protected from the ever-growing forces of darkness, and there's even a dragon.

What makes *Bone* so special is Smith's refusal to be in any limited by the structure of the epic fantasy tale. His fantastic sense of humour seems both out of place and yet completely perfect, as Phoney Bone's schemes consistently go awry. It's unclear where exactly this story is taking place or when, but his gift for balancing character and humanity with this increasingly grand tale keeps us invested throughout.

The character design, too, feels completely unique, and works in tandem with Fone Bone's essential innocence and good nature to create a savvy but utterly lovable tale.

